

tation. Readers get used to the look and feel of your blog, and though we can't say never to redesign it, it should either be a very occasional revamping, or small, incremental changes.

What happens if you can't think of anything to write about? Well, if you're passionate enough about your subject(s), this shouldn't happen. A good idea for the occasional time when you just can't think of anything is to ramble a little—about yourself, for example—like we mentioned earlier. (But don't overdo it.) It's better than no post at all! Also, you could always revisit an old post and give your readers updates on the matter... memory spans, like attention spans, are getting shorter.

It's as with anything else—like going to the gym, for example. Inertia, once it creeps in, can spread like a cancer through your system.

3.9 Writing Skills

Be on a constant run to improve your writing skills. Form is as important as content. You don't need to be able to write a gripping thriller, but everyone likes to read a *well-written* blog. Grammar and punctuation is one thing—which we've already mentioned; maintaining a style is one thing—which also we've already mentioned; but the bottomline is, to be famous (which, we're assuming, is your idealistic ultimate goal), you need to write well.

We can't teach you how to write well. But when we say "writing well," we're referring to such things as twisting phrases to make them more interesting; using language to make a dull topic more approachable; making your posts gripping enough to hold your readers' attention for at least the span of the post; avoiding clichés and clichéd phrases; not going into "lyrical digression"—where the writer increases word count and wastes bandwidth by avoiding the central topic and beating round the bush and only then coming back to the point at hand, as we have done with this phrase.